

Ada Lovelace

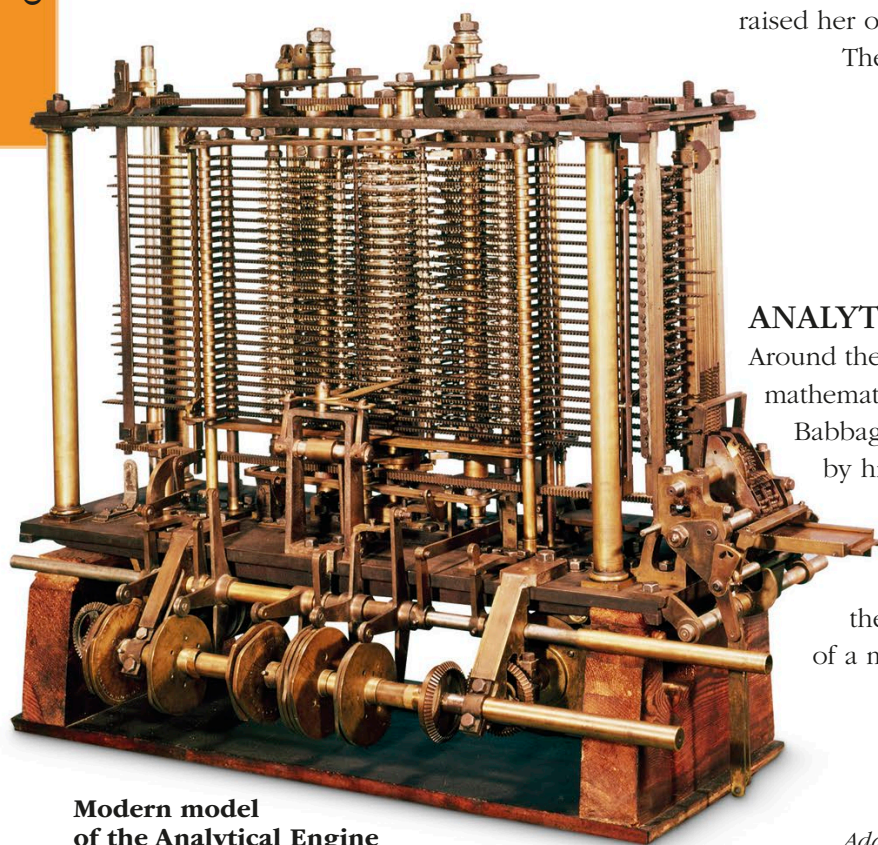
Ada Lovelace was born August Ada Gordon in 1815. Her father was the romantic English poet George Gordon, better known as Lord Byron. Ada became a mathematician in later life. She wrote what is regarded as the first computer program and her ideas inspired work on early computing in the mid-20th century.

A SCIENTIFIC EDUCATION

Ada's parents divorced when she was young.

Fearing Ada would inherit her father's unpredictable temperament, her mother raised her on science and mathematics.

The young Ada was fascinated by the new inventions of the Industrial Revolution.



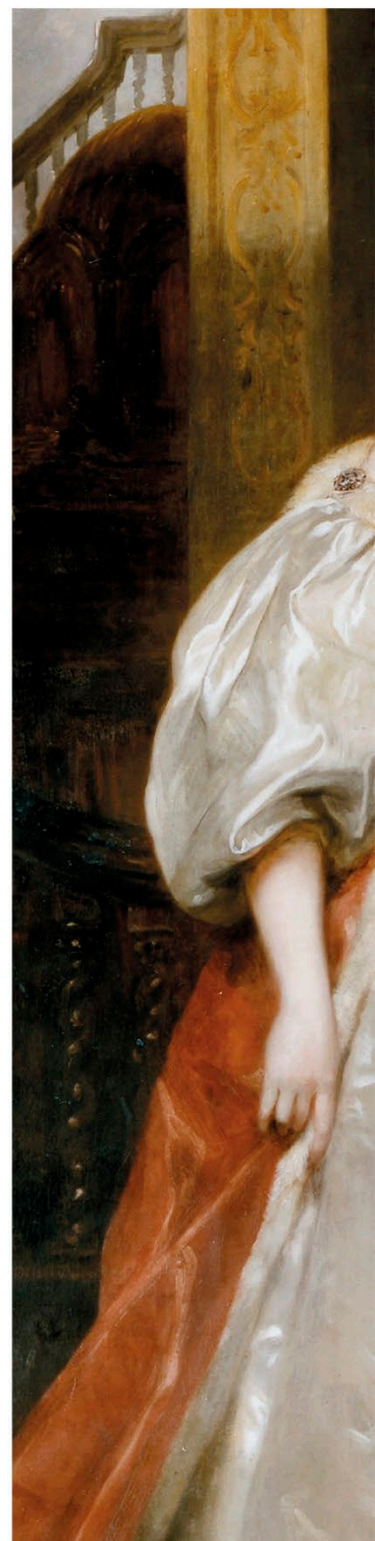
Modern model of the Analytical Engine

ANALYTICAL ENGINE

Around the age of 17, Ada met mathematician and inventor Charles Babbage. She became intrigued by his ideas for an “analytical engine” which could perform complicated calculations. It had all the essential elements of a modern computer.

► ADA LOVELACE

Ada married the Earl of Lovelace—her proper title is Lady Ada King, Countess of Lovelace.



LIFE STORY

1815

In December, Ada Gordon is born in London, the only legitimate child of the romantic poet George Gordon, Lord Byron.

1816

In January, her mother, Annabella, leaves her father, whom she considers insane, and takes one-month-old Ada with her.

1828

Ada is a clever and gifted child and, at the age of 13, designs her own flying machine.

1833

She is introduced to mathematician and inventor Charles Babbage.

Punched cards for Babbage's machine

